ALX DATA ANALYTICS · PROBLEM FRAMING

Reporting Tool Adoption After a Legacy System Shutdown

A problem framing study of Operations Team Managers

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Mr. Issa El Hiani

Operations Team Manager

	Age	35 Years Old
	Location	Finance City., Casablanca
	Occupation	Ops Team Manager
	Business	Outsourcing

USER BEHAVIORS

Team Leadership — 84%

Technical Expertise — 70%

Digital Experience — 67%

Customer Communication — 90%

FRUSTRATIONS

- "I don't understand why we are changing to a new reporting tool."
- "I attended the new tool training and I understood the content but I cannot come to use it right now."
- "I would have delivered the training differently if it were up to me."

GOALS

- Understand the new reporting tool
- Tracking and reporting team performance efficiently

BACKGROUND

- BEEN A TEAM MANAGER FOR 4 YEARS
- MANAGES CLIENTS' AND CUSTOMERS' ESCALATION EFFICIENTLY
- GOOD QUALITATIVE RESULTS TRACK RECORD

QUOTE

"I have been using the old tool since my promotion and it was working fine, they did not explain why change now.
For now, I just need to understand why we are using this new tool and how do I use it"

EMPATHY MAP · MR. ISSA EL HIANI

What he thinks, feels, says and does

THINKS

- “Why push a tool upgrade without explaining how it fits?”

FEELS

- Frustrated by mechanical training (“Where to click”).
- Anxious about team data error spikes affecting KPIs.
- Responsible for keeping daily floor delivery accurate.

SAYS

- “We need a standard way to transition without breaking work.”
- “I understand how to click buttons, but not how to fix data.”

DOES

- Reverts to offline Excel trackers to protect daily output.
- Balances team stress while attempting official tool compliance.

BROAD PROBLEM STATEMENT

Operations team managers are struggling to adopt the newly introduced reporting tool following legacy system deprecation, leading to post-training performance gaps, operational friction, and daily reporting delays.

PROBLEM SPACE EXPLORATION · 5 WHYS

From the symptom to the root cause

WHY 1	**Why are managers struggling to adopt the new tool?**	They do not know how to integrate it into daily floor workflows, and keep reverting to manual habits.
WHY 2	**Why can’t they integrate it into daily work?**	The training covered only mechanics (“which buttons to click”), not practical operational application.
WHY 3	**Why did the training focus only on button-clicking?**	Leadership rolled the tool out as an IT software upgrade, not as an operational change.
WHY 4	**Why was it treated as an IT upgrade?**	The legacy system was abruptly deprecated (view-only mode), forcing a shift with no structured transition plan.
WHY 5 · ROOT CAUSE	**Why was there no transition plan or change management support?**	The organization has no standardized change management framework, so tools are pushed out without strategic awareness, a communicated “why”, or work on manager mindsets.

RESEARCH SUMMARY AND SOURCES

What the research says about failed change

Harvard DCE blog: 7 reasons change management strategies fail

Summary. Change fails when the strategy ignores how the change will happen, leaders stop communicating after launch, and employee resistance is not addressed early.

Role. Supports the 5 Whys: managers were not told why the tool changed, and no one addressed their resistance.

professional.dce.harvard.edu

Schwarz, Bouckenooghe and Vakola (2021), Human Relations

Summary. An editorial that models change failure as a process across three layers: surface (visible context), intermediate (how people make sense of the change) and deep (underlying norms and basic choices).

Role. Gives a way to read the 5 Whys: trackers and error spikes are the surface, managers' view of the change is the intermediate layer, the missing change framework is the deep structure.

journals.sagepub.com/doi/abs/10.1177/0018726720942297

Tony Schwartz: interior and exterior dimensions of change

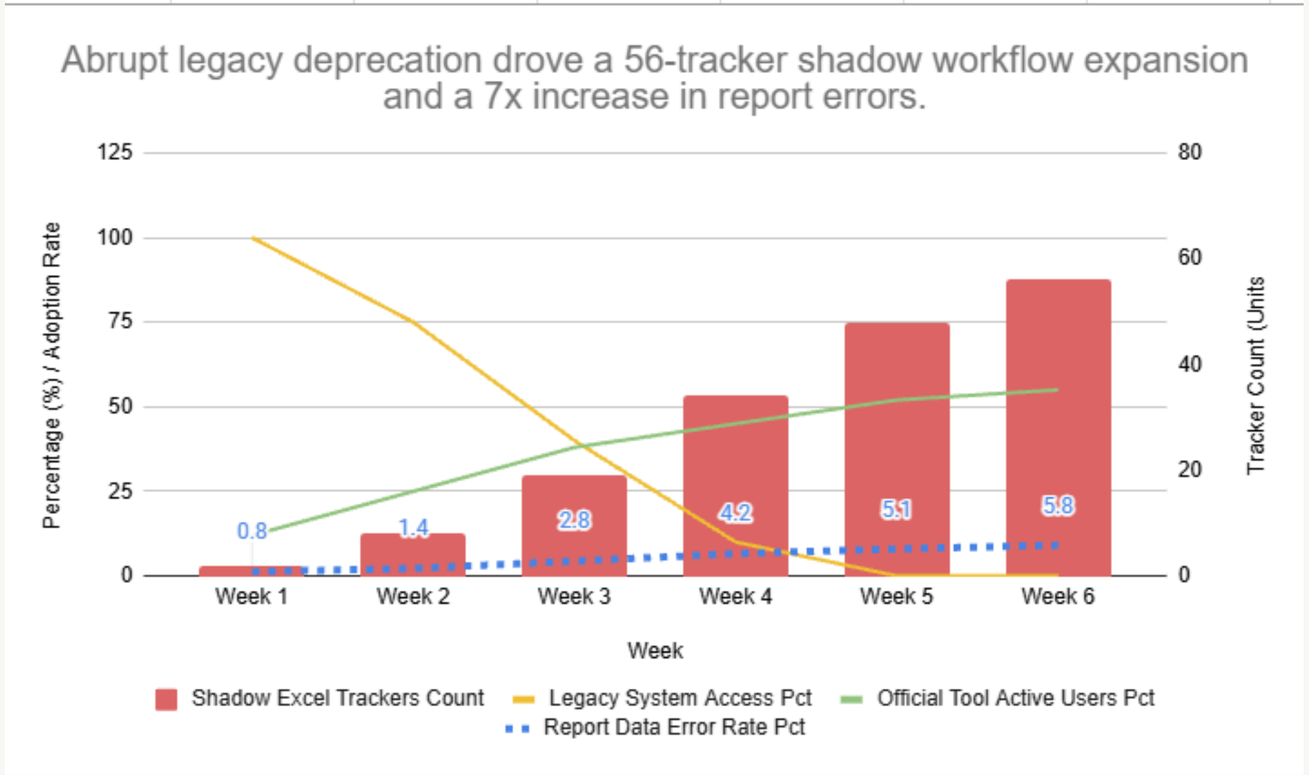
Summary. Change needs a balance between exterior dimensions (systems, tools, metrics) and interior ones (mindsets, emotional readiness, psychological safety, buy-in).

Role. Helps explain the shadow trackers: when the interior side is ignored, managers can build unauthorized trackers as protection. A practitioner view, so context rather than proof.

linkedin.com/posts/toschwartz (LinkedIn post)

DATA INSIGHT · 1 OF 3

Shadow trackers and report errors

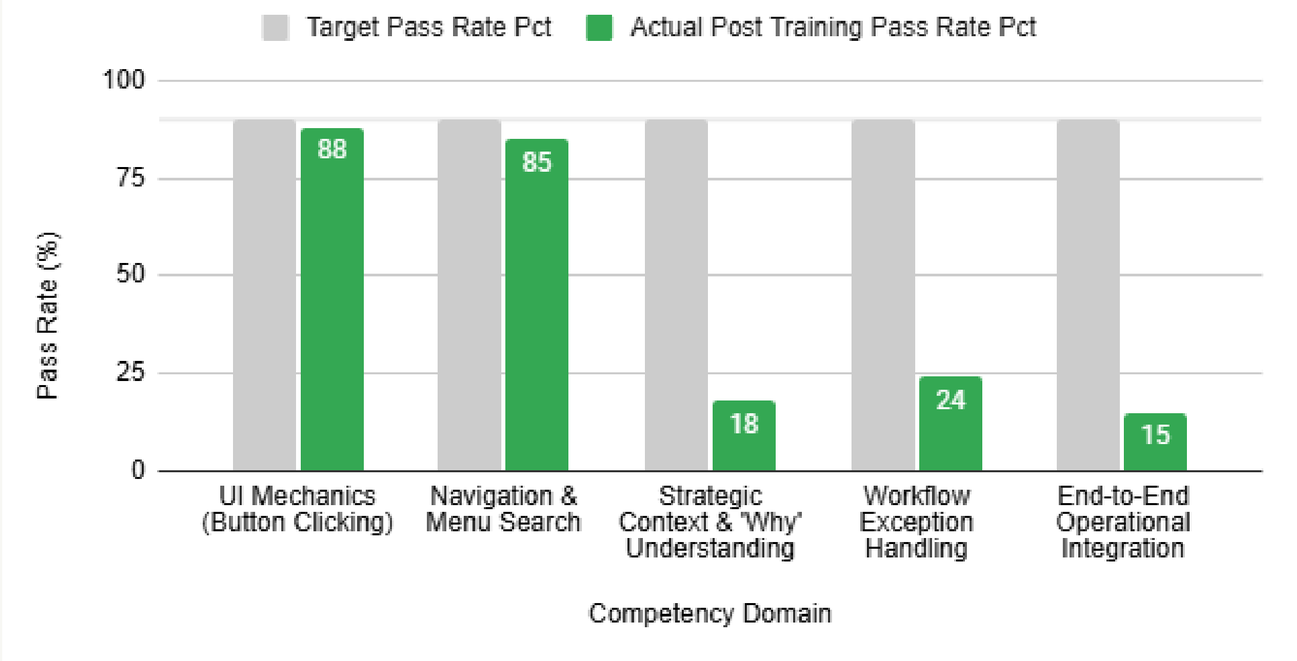


INSIGHT

Cutting legacy access from 100% to 0% without a change framework did not produce adoption: the new tool plateaued at 55% of users. Managers created 56 unauthorized offline Excel trackers to keep operations running. Over the same six weeks, report error rates rose more than sevenfold, from 0.8% to 5.8%.

DATA INSIGHT · 2 OF 3

Training results by competency



INSIGHT

The training taught the software mechanics (UI button clicking: 88% pass rate against a 90% benchmark) but failed beyond them: strategic rationale (18%), workflow exception handling (24%) and end-to-end operational integration (15%). The data points to a flaw in the training and change design rather than a limit in managers' capacity to learn.

DATA INSIGHT · 3 OF 3

ADKAR diagnostic scores

Stage	Score (out of 10)	Status	What the score reflects
Awareness	2.5	Critical barrier	Missing rationale
Desire	3.1	High friction	Perceived loss of efficiency
Knowledge	8.2	Sufficient	Mechanical button-clicking training
Ability	4.0	Moderate friction	Lack of workflow support
Reinforcement	1.8	Critical barrier	No audits or sponsorship

INSIGHT

Knowledge scored well (8.2) because the training taught button-clicking. The change still stalled because Awareness (2.5) and Reinforcement (1.8) were neglected, and managers reverted to unauthorized shadow Excel trackers. Ability (4.0) is held back by missing workflow support, not by capacity to learn.

FINAL PROBLEM STATEMENT

The abrupt deprecation of legacy reporting systems (100% → 0% access) without a structured transition plan or change support leaves Operations Team Managers maintaining **56 unauthorized offline Excel trackers**. Grounded in change-readiness diagnostics (ADKAR Awareness **2.5/10** and Reinforcement **1.8/10**), the gap between mechanical UI competency (**88%**) and deep operational integration (**15%**) coincides with floor report data error rates rising more than sevenfold (**0.8% → 5.8%**), putting SLA compliance, operational predictability and reporting data integrity at risk.

OPPORTUNITIES FOR ACTION

1. Build and implement an ADKAR-based change management framework

Targets the critical barriers: Awareness (2.5/10) and Reinforcement (1.8/10).

2. Redesign training from UI mechanics to operational workflow integration

Targets the gaps in strategic rationale (18%), workflow exceptions (24%) and end-to-end integration (15%).